than itself—namely, Europe's advanced industrial democracies.[24] On the other hand, in the World Bank negotiations leading up to the 2010 provisional deal, China chose to be generous, taking less than the additional quota that it might have claimed due to its relative economic size.[25]

Throughout the long delays before reforms were approved and implemented, the BRICS coordinated extensively, mostly on the sidelines of the G20 and similar meetings of multilateral institutions.[26] Although the BRICS' view of Europeans as a bloc in the IMF was somewhat exaggerated, given they did not coordinate (let alone agree) on all important issues, club dynamics were apparently more prevalent in the BRICS in this case than among the incumbent powers, which benefited more from holding to the status quo than the harder task of trying to build consensus to change it. The degree of BRICS coordination varied from informal and ad hoc, such as among EDs in the IMF, to more focused and concrete, at BRICS summits and when senior ministers met at the G20 and on the sidelines of other multilateral gatherings.[27]

This case also demonstrates how BRICS collaboration benefited from quantitative analytical work done by experts both in BRICS governments and in academia, working on proposals to revise the existing IMF formula for determining quota shares to break the informal power of Western countries. For example, prominent Russia economists from the Academy of Sciences and the independent Russian Economic School (RESh) weighed in publicly with their research and criticisms of the existing formula, which heavily favored the Europeans and the incumbent powers overall. Russian Finance Minister Anton Siliuanov dismissed it as not reflecting the real situation in the world economy and creating blatant inconsistencies. Sergei Guriev, then rector of RESh and currently chief economist at the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD), argued that the BRICS' IMF reform proposals are "not radical enough." Guriev's view, that "control rights in the IMF should stay with the net creditors," is widely supported in Russia as a slap at the United States,[28] although not universally in the BRICS, since some members like Brazil are debtors while many Western economies like Japan or Germany are creditors. IMF quotas, in this view, not only overrepresent the West in proportion to their actual share of the global economy, but also underrate creditors like China, which are needed to increase funding to the IMF in the future. According to Gureiv, "if BRICS